

Accidental or occasional use

PREVENTION

WHAT IT IS

- **First contact** with pornography.
- It happens **occasionally (not compulsively)**.
- There is a feeling of discomfort combined with physiological arousal.
- It may come from: curiosity, adolescence itself, **accidental contact** (the internet or friends), managing anxiety or seeking pleasure.

CONSEQUENCES

- **Early use** can predispose to developing problematic use.
- It can produce **unpleasant emotions**: shame, disgust, fear or guilt.
- It is the **gateway to risky use**.
- It leaves a mark on the person's affective and sexual learning.
- An experience of **loneliness and/or emptiness**.

KEY POINTS

- Do not overreact.
- Explain what pornography is and warn of possible risks.
- Develop a family plan for prevention.
- It is an educational opportunity.

Habitual use

ATTENTION

WHAT IT IS

- Use has settled and is **frequent**.
- They use it to **manage certain emotions** such as stress, boredom or social isolation.
- A certain **dependence** on it for managing emotions develops.
- They have **normalised** it and have little awareness of its possible risks.

CONSEQUENCES

- It creates **false expectations** about affection and sexuality.
- It brings in stereotypes linked to violence against women.
- It can affect their **self-esteem** and self-concept.
- It can encourage **isolation and loneliness**.
- There is an **imminent risk of developing problematic use or addiction**.

KEY POINTS

- Accompany the teenager with empathy and without judging them personally.
- Look at the reasons for use and offer alternatives.
- Assess the use with a professional to determine its impact.
- Offer critical thinking to tell pornography apart from sexuality.

Problematic use

INTERVENTION

WHAT IT IS

- **Loss of control** over the behaviour.
- They do it **compulsively and/or anxiously**.
- They show an **inability to stop** and/or failed attempts to give up the behaviour.
- **Deception, lies and concealment** about it.
- They manage their emotions exclusively through pornography.
- They may show **symptoms of addiction** (tolerance, withdrawal or relapses).

CONSEQUENCES

- Development of a **serious addiction** sustained over time.
- Serious impact on **affective and sexual relationships**.
- Effects on **mood** and affect.
- **Harmful consequences** in different areas: academic, personal, romantic, social, sexual, family and/or spiritual.

KEY POINTS

- See a specialist.